Syllabus Edition
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Employment Contracts

Exam code: 0450, 0986 & 0264, 0774

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Employment contracts

- An employment contract is a **legal agreement between the employer and employee,** which sets out the terms and conditions of employment
  - It is usually a **legal requirement** for employers to provide a new employee with a contract of employment
- The **contract of employment** will usually include
  - The names of employee and employer
  - Employment start date
  - Working hours
  - Remuneration
  - Holiday entitlement
  - Duties and responsibilities of the role
  - Place of work
  - Sick pay and parental leave
  - Notice period
- The main types of contract **include full-time, part-time, job share** and **zero hours contracts**
  - Often, a business will have a mixture of employees with a **range of different employment contracts**

Benefits of employment contracts

For the employer	For the employee
• The contract clearly sets out the rules, such as working hours, duties, and pay, helping to reduce confusion or disputes	• The contract gives clear information about their job role, working hours, pay, and holidays, so they know exactly what to expect

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they break the contract, such as refusing to work agreed hours	easily change terms or dismiss the worker without good reason
• It helps to create a professional relationship, where both sides understand their responsibilities and can work more effectively together	• If the employer breaks the contract (e.g. underpaying or reducing hours unfairly), the employee has the right to take legal action

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Don't forget that employment contracts protect **both** employer and employee – mentioning benefits to each side will make your answers more balanced and exam-ready

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